

Halo Effect

<https://sway.cloud.microsoft/u9NfDqQqYvnWFM8A?ref=Link>

Decide if the following statements about the video are true (T) or false (F). Then watch and check.

1. The halo effect is when we have a positive attitude towards something and attribute qualities to it that it does not have.
2. Frederick Well conducted a study on leadership skills.
3. The results of the evaluation showed that those who did well physically didn't perform as highly when it came to leadership.
4. The problem was that the subjects of the study found it difficult to look at individual qualities separately, and just saw individuals in generally positive or negative terms.
5. There were people whose performance was seen as poor no matter what they did.

Check what you remember and tick all of the following sentences which describe what happened in a study in school.

1. 4,500 students were sorted into three groups according to their looks.
2. Students who were rated below average looking were often seen as being more intelligent.
3. A school of 4,500 students were given a test to complete in class.
4. Marks were compared between classes taken face-to-face and those taken online.
5. Students who were rated as average looking had more friends.
6. 4,500 students were put into six classes based on how good looking they were.
7. Students who were rated as more attractive performed worse in a virtual classroom according to results.

You are going to read an article about the Halo Effect. Look through the text and decide whether the text supports the video.

The Halo Effect In the Workplace

A. ____

There are a variety of decisions we all have to make in our working lives. When it comes to people, we all have instinctive preferences that help us navigate these decisions as to who we want to work with, who we trust, and who we don't. This allows us to make choices more quickly, a vital tool in any work environment. However, when relying on our natural inclinations too heavily, we can be prone to manipulation from factors we're unaware of. The Halo Effect is what happens when we give our first impressions about someone too much importance in the way we evaluate them later on.

B. ____

The degree to which we find someone attractive can obviously affect our first impressions, but in the office, there are other factors at play. For example, if you meet someone and they have the same tastes in music, or they make you laugh. Maybe they are wearing a jacket that you really like, or they've been endorsed by someone who you know and respect. Perhaps they perform a fairly simple task particularly well early on in their job? All of these things can lead to us giving that person credit for being a better performer than they actually are based on evidence.

C. ____

When the Halo Effect colours the view of decision-making at management level, or in Human Resources, it will invariably lead to unequal treatment of employees, particularly when it comes to performance reviews. This could easily, and perhaps understandably, lead to resentment from those who don't feel its benefits. Worse still, the flip side of the Halo Effect: the Horn Effect, could affect employees who, for whatever reason, are viewed in a less favourable way, even if it's nothing to do with their performance and feel as if they are constantly swimming against the tide. It can also lead to a lack of diversity in the workforce if particular traits are indirectly highlighted as being desirable. You don't have to look far for tales of people getting promoted partly because they went to the same university as the hiring manager or play golf at the same club.

D. ____

There are steps you can take to make the performance reviews process fair. Firstly, make sure that it is standardised and everyone receives the same questions with scores that are balanced evenly. The scores need to be based on measurable aspects of the job, not opinion. A further method is a 360 review where feedback on performance is taken from different departments, colleagues and possibly customers that the employee interacts with. This will greatly cut down on the possibility of the manager's view alone being the deciding factor. There's also performance management software which can track feedback over a period of time. This could be useful in a situation where a worker has more than one manager to report to, either at the same time or over a period of time, and the feedback varies considerably between them. This will help HR to identify if there's a difference in the performance or biases involved.

Sources: HR Daily Advisor, PerformYard, Psychology Today

B. Match the following titles to paragraphs A - D. There are more titles than paragraphs.

1. What causes the Halo Effect?
2. What effects can the Halo Effect have on companies?
3. How to avoid the Halo Effect
4. Which countries have more problems with the Halo Effect?
5. What is the Halo Effect?
6. What problems can the Halo Effect cause?

Complete the following sentences with no more than three words.

1. Our natural with people help us decide who we want to communicate with and who we don't, which helps us navigate through thousands of social interactions.
2. When we give our too much power, we can let them continue to inform the way we think about someone, despite not having the evidence to back it up.
3. If you share similar in culture such as films, comedy, and music with someone, then it's easy to have an overly positive view of that person.
4. If a person is recommended for a job by a close colleague who you, then this is another reason for giving that person a lot more credit than they may be due.

5. by managers and human resources staff can be altered by the Halo Effect.
6. The main issue with the Halo Effect in companies is when it results in by management of people in their team.
7. Left unchecked, it can create a complete as managers consistently hire similar people.

Which of the following measures does the article suggest to combat the effects of the Halo Effect in performance reviews?

1. Asking staff to write their own feedback and getting the team to review it to see if they agree.
2. Having feedback from multiple staff that the person under review interacts with.
3. Ensuring that the questions that all employees are asked are the same.
4. Making sure that the reviewer is of the same gender as the person under review.
5. Having feedback given by different managers each time.
6. Using software to monitor an employee's performance over time to see if issues are long or short-term.

Discuss the following questions.

1. Do you think that The Halo Effect may have been a problem in any places where you have worked? Why/why not?
2. What other situations do you think the Halo Effect may be a problem in other than in the workplace?
3. Who have you met in the past who may have had the Halo Effect on you? Why did that happen?
4. Can you think of anyone you've worked with who created the Horn Effect with their manager? Why was that?

Find vocabulary in the article which has the same meaning as the following definitions.

1. knowing something without thinking or studying it (adj., para. A)
2. a feeling of wanting to do something (n, para. A)
3. behaviour that is aimed at changing the way others think or act without them realising it, often in a way that is dishonest (n, para. A)
4. publicly support someone or something (v, para. B)
5. recognition for doing something positive (n, para. B)
6. a feeling of unhappiness or anger with a situation that you think is not fair (n, para. C)
7. being attractive to people (adj., para. C)
8. a feeling which strongly prefers one side of an argument or groups of people over others without being balanced or logical (n, para. D)

Talk about someone who had the Halo Effect on you.

Consider the following questions:

- Why did you have very positive first impressions of them to begin with?
- What did you give them credit for that they weren't really doing?
- Did you change your mind about them? Why/Why not?
- What would you do differently if you were in the same situation again?
- What sort of people are most likely to create The Halo Effect with you? Why?